Assessment Information Guide

This Assessment Information Guide has been designed to help you to successfully complete the assessment for unit/s.

Documents

A number of learning contents have been provided with this Assessment Information to support you to complete training and assessment including:

- *Learner Guide*: The Learner Guide provides you with learning content, activities and links to videos, further reading and additional material to help you to develop your knowledge and skills.
- *Assessment Tasks*: The assessments for this unit are divided into separate tasks, in accordance with the unit of competency requirements. You can access these tasks via the Learner Portal. Each task includes detailed instructions and guidance to support you in completing the assessment. Information on how to submit your work, along with any required forms, is also provided within the portal.
- *Supporting resources*: Supporting resources include templates, forms, and portfolios designed to help you provide evidence of your competence. These resources can be accessed through the Learning Plan or the aXcelerate Resource Library. Your assessor may also provide specific resources when you are ready to complete each assessment. A list of student resources relevant to each task is available in the Learning Plan or within the specific Assessment Task that requires them..

Key information

Safety

Regardless of the training or assessment setting, you must always work safely and comply with legislative requirements. Listen to and follow the direction of your trainer/assessor at all times.

Policies and procedures

The information in this guide is general in nature and should always be read in conjunction with Milestones International College's Student Handbook.

Preparing for assessment

Much of the quality of your assessment relies on the planning and preparation that you do. Take the time to:

- carefully read through the whole of the assessment task and each of the supporting documents
- ensure that you are clear about what it is that you are expected to do. Ask your assessor for clarification if you have any questions at all
- be clear on the time limits and due dates for each task
- ensure that you have completed a Student Assessment Agreement and Student Declaration upon submission of assessment tasks for every unit of competency.

Understand expectations

You will find specific advice at the start of each assessment which will guide you in how to complete each assessment task. Make sure that you take the time to read this advice and to clarify any legislative and organisational requirements before proceeding with assessment.

Always ensure that you are clear about what is expected of you. If you need support, advice or assistance, speak to your trainer, your assessor or your workplace supervisor.

Time limits and due dates

You are provided with your due dates in Axcelerate both on the homepage for your unit/cluster and the assessment section. In some cases, you will also be required to complete an assessment within a set time for instance an in class demonstration or presentation.

Please ensure you are aware of the due dates.

Milestones offer reasonable adjustments on assessments.

Reasonable adjustment

Students who experience unforeseen circumstances or have special needs that affect their performance in an assessment may be eligible to apply for a special consideration and reasonable adjustment to assessment.

Note:

- Adjustments to assessment cannot compromise the integrity of assessment, elements and performance criteria of the unit of competency, and any adjustments to assessment will not provide an unfair advantage / disadvantage to students.
- Students need to complete the Request for Reasonable Adjustment and Special Consideration form.
- The RTO manager must approve the request prior to its implementation.

See Milestones International College's Reasonable Adjustment and Special Consideration Policy here.

Undertaking assessment

Types of assessment

The Student Assessment Tasks incorporate a range of assessment styles including:

- knowledge questions
- research tasks
- assessor observations
- portfolios
- projects, which may include case studies
- role plays

Knowledge questions

Knowledge Questions are designed to help you to demonstrate the knowledge which you have acquired during the unit. Knowledge questions can be completed in a variety of ways including:

- in a traditional, closed-book exam style setting in the classroom
- in an open-book setting in the classroom. This means that you can draw on your learning materials and other resources to answer questions
- in an open-book setting in your own time
- via Axcelerate, your Milestones International College's learning management system (LMS)
- as verbal questions if required for the purposes of reasonable adjustment as per reasonable adjustment policy.

You should also refer to the section on Completing Written Assessment Tasks below for additional information.

Research tasks

Research tasks are provided to help you to demonstrate your ability to conduct and analyse research or to gather information. They also help you demonstrate your knowledge about a particular topic. When completing research tasks, consider the following tips.

- Ensure that you accurately quote your sources (including on-line sources).
- Use information from reliable, relevant sources.
- Use information sources that are current (while there are exceptions, a good guide is not more than six years old).

You should also refer to the section on Completing Written Assessment Tasks below for additional information.

Projects

Projects are provided to help you demonstrate a range of knowledge and skills that you have developed during your course. They may be completed in your own workplace, in a simulated workplace, in the classroom or in your own time. Supporting templates and resources are usually provided to help you. They often have a range of tasks within them which will include observations and portfolio completion.

You should also refer to the section on Completing Written Assessment Tasks below for additional information.

Assessor observations

Assessor observations are used where the unit of competency requires that you must be observed by an assessor demonstrating the skills and knowledge that you have learnt during your course. Before being observed, make sure that you read through the task information so that you understand what it is that you must demonstrate. Your assessor will advise you of when you will be observed for the purposes of assessment.

Observations may be in person, via video conferencing software as and when necessary/relevant (e.g. pandemic conditions or distance-based learners) or you may like to video record evidence for your assessor to watch later. When submitting video evidence ensure the quality is suitable enough for the assessor to clearly observe what you are doing and that the audio quality is sufficient. Otherwise, you may be asked to resubmit.

Observation checklists are provided for all activities that require direct observation. These checklists outline the specific criteria your assessor will use to evaluate your performance. To be marked as Satisfactory for the assessment task, you must ensure that all criteria are fully addressed.

Round table discussions

Round table discussions are a fantastic way for you to discuss your own real experiences and apply them in the context of the case study. Even though you may be participating in a project based on a case study business, you have a wealth of knowledge, experience and skills that you have gathered over the course of your life that can be reflected on and applied in discussion with your peers and fellow students. These can then be discussed and applied to the project you are working on, making it more industry realistic.

Role plays

Role plays are used to assess your knowledge and skills where it would not be possible to provide evidence in another way. For example, many Human Resources (HR) units will require you to demonstrate competency in processes like recruitment or termination of employment.

When participating in role plays, ensure that you behave as you would in a real workplace. You will find more information about simulated workplaces below.

Simulated workplace environments

Many of the student assessment tasks that you undertake throughout your course will take place in the simulated business environment which could include your home and/or classroom. Simulated workplace tasks are designed to:

- reflect real life work tasks
- are assessed using criteria that relate to the quality of work expected by industry
- use authentic workplace documentation
- require you to work as part of a team
- involve the use of standard, workplace equipment (hardware, software and consumables)
- require you to consider usual workplace constraints such as time and budgets.

You should therefore ensure that you treat simulated workplaces as real workplaces for the purposes of assessment by:

- communicating professionally, using industry standard language and terminology
- adhering to an appropriate level of dress and behaviour
- working in a way which is client or team focussed (as relevant to the unit)
- completing group work in a professional, team-oriented way
- behaving in a way which is consistent with current industry practice.

Assessment task cover sheets

You must submit a completed, signed Assessment Task Cover Sheet with each assessment. An Assessment Task Cover Sheet is included in this Assessment Guide.

Submission instructions

The format that you will submit tasks in will vary, depending on the task. Some might require hand-written responses, some will require submission of electronic files and others will require emails. You will find specific instructions with each task. However your final assessment and any accompanying files and documents should be submitted into Milestones International College's Learning Management System known as Axcelerate.

You need to complete your assessment.

For knowledge assessments, please follow the Written response guidance below.

For any projects or portfolios where you are required to upload separate documents as a part of your assessment evidence, save your document on your computer in Microsoft Word/Pdf format. You may also have additional files such as video or other media files, excel etc.

We suggest you save your document as follows:

- Unit Code
- Your first name and initial of last name.
- Capitalise only the first letter of names.
- Then insert a dash, followed by submission attempt

As an example of incorporating the four points above your file name or subject line should appear this way: Unit code – SallyA #1

Students ***must*** also complete the Student Assessment Agreement and Student Declaration upon submission of assessment tasks for every unit of competency.

File naming conventions

It is important that you use a consistent file naming convention for each file that you submit. For all files that you submit throughout the assessment for this course, use the following convention:

competency code First name Surname Letter – Submission Attempt

For example: BSBWRT411 – SallyA #1

Completing written assessment tasks

The following advice applies to completing all types of written assessment (for example, knowledge questions, research reports, project portfolios and so on).

- You should always apply the documentation principles that you have learned throughout your course when answering written questions, completing assessment tasks and presenting reports. In particular, you should:
  - use clear, non-discriminatory language
  - use business-like language
  - follow your workplace's policies and procedures
  - respect the confidentiality of the people who you are providing services and support to.
- Read each question carefully and focus on answering it in full. For example, if the question asks you to list five of something, ensure that you provide five examples.

Written response guidance

Knowledge Questions and other tasks which require a written response use a range of "instructional words" such as "identify" or "explain", which tell you how you should answer the question. Use the definitions below to assist you to provide the type of responses expected.

Note that the following guidance is the minimum level of response required.

Analyse: when a question asks you to analyse something, you should do so in detail, and identify important points and key features. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Compare: when a question asks you to compare something, you will need to show how two or more things are similar, ensuring that you also indicate the relevance of the consequences. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Contrast: when a question asks you to contrast something, you will need to show how two or more things are different, ensuring you indicate the relevance or the consequences. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Describe: when a question asks you to describe something, you should state the most noticeable qualities or features. Generally, you are expected to write a response two or three sentences long.

Discuss: when a question asks you to discuss something, you are required to point out important issues or features and express some form of critical judgement. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Evaluate: when a question asks you to evaluate something, you should put forward arguments for and against something. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Examine: when a question asks you to examine something, this is similar to "analyse", where you should provide a detailed response with key points and features and provide critical analysis. Generally, you are expected to write a response one or two paragraphs long.

Explain: when a question asks you to explain something, you should make clear how or why something happened or the way it is. Generally, you are expected to write a response two or three sentences long.

Identify: when a question asks you to identify something, this means that you are asked to briefly describe the required information. Generally, you are expected to write a response two or three sentences long.

List: when a question asks you to list something, this means that you are asked to briefly state information in a list format.

Outline: when a question asks you to outline something, this means giving only the main points, Generally, you are expected to write a response a few sentences long.

Summarise: when a question asks you to summarise something, this means (like "outline") only giving the main points. Generally, you are expected to write a response a few sentences long.

Academic Integrity Policy: Plagiarism, cheating and collusion

Students must ensure all submitted work is their own, properly cited, and completed in accordance with Milestones International College's Academic Integrity Policy: Plagiarism, Cheating and Collusion

Definitions

Plagiarism: Using someone else's work, ideas, or expressions without proper acknowledgment.

Cheating: Any attempt to gain an unfair advantage in an academic assessment, including but not limited to:

- Copying from another student.
- Using unauthorized materials during an exam.
- Falsifying data or results.

Collusion: Unauthorized collaboration with another person in the preparation or completion of work for academic credit.

Consequences

Consequences for academic misconduct vary based on the severity and context but can include:

- Completion and resubmission of a new assessment task; and/or
- All parties receiving a "Not Yet Satisfactory" result for the assessment task;
- Verbal or written warning; and/or
- Suspension or expulsion from the course

Following assessment

Once you complete and submit each assessment task, your assessor will mark it and return it to you with an outcome: either *Satisfactory (S) or Unsatisfactory (U)*.

If your submission is assessed as Unsatisfactory, your assessor will discuss the outcome with you and advise you on available reassessment opportunities, in accordance with Milestones International College's Assessment Conduct Policy.

Your assessor will also inform you of the timeframe for resubmission, based on Milestones International College's Reassessment Policy and Procedure.

Please note:

- Learners wishing to submit assessments more than four (4) months after the unit or course commencement date may be required to re-enrol and pay the current course fee.
- Learners are permitted one (1) resubmission for assessments marked Not Yet Competent.
- Learners who fail to submit an assessment on their first attempt may be referred to the RTO Manager for an early intervention meeting regarding their course progress.
- A fee may apply for a second resubmission, at the discretion of the RTO Manager

Right of appeal

You have the right to appeal the outcome of assessment decisions if you feel that you have been dealt with unfairly or have other appropriate grounds for an appeal.

You should refer to your Milestones International College's assessment appeals process for more information.